



CAREER TWISTER

Priyanka **CHOPRA**, 26

Rs 2 crore per movie, seven brands at over Rs 2 crore each

COMING UP *Dostana*, a fun, young, urban and very gay comedy

“ I take my work seriously. It doesn't stop at pack-up. ”

Khan, Anil Kapoor and Zayed Khan.

It's not unusual. Four years ago, Aishwarya Rai, Rani Mukerji and Preity Zinta were the gilded lilies. Between them, they had the finest directors, the best endorsements and the tabloid space. But that was then. Now Kareena is working with Rajkumar Hirani in *3 Idiots* opposite Aamir Khan, Priyanka is wrapping up a film with Vishal Bhardwaj and about to start one with Ashutosh Gowariker, while Katrina, in a huge departure from her sensuous swan image, is playing a "very simple girl" in Rajkumar Santoshi's *Ajab Prem ki Gazab Kahani* and a "no make-up part" in Prakash Jha's *Rajniti*. Kareena has seven brands, Priyanka

is the face of another seven while Katrina pushes six products.

It's not been easy. All of them often work 14-hour days, if not more, and make sure they're surrounded by the right people to advise them. Priyanka's "fantastic four" has a manager to handle her films, another manager to look after her ads, a publicist and an assistant for "the personal stuff". Kareena and Katrina share the same media company and endorsement agency, apart from separate secretaries who manage their film schedules. Clearly, they've learned to delegate to keep their brands alive. As Priyanka says, "There was a time when I would try to do everything on my own, whether it